

" Dr. Achyuta Samanta Makes History as First Indian Recipient of FIVB Grand Cross Award "

In a world where sports transcend boundaries and unite nations, few individuals have worked as tirelessly as Dr. Achyuta Samanta to ensure that young talents are nurtured and opportunities are created. The Founder of KIIT and KISS has added yet another feather to his already illustrious cap, being honoured with the Grand Cross Award—the highest accolade of the International Volleyball Federation (FIVB). This prestigious recognition, conferred during the 39th FIVB World Congress in Porto, Portugal, demonstrates his unwavering commitment to the development of sports.

The three-day event, held from November 15 to 17, was a gathering of global volleyball leaders, with representatives from 222 countries in attendance. Amid this distinguished assembly, Dr. Samanta shone brightly. FIVB President Dr. Ary S. Graça F° presented the award, highlighting the exceptional role Dr. Samanta has played in not just popularizing volleyball but also fostering sportsmanship at large.

For Dr. Samanta, this moment of glory was a culmination of years of dedication. "I am deeply indebted to Lord Jagannath for this recognition and dedicate this award to Him," he said in his acceptance speech. True to his inclusive vision, he also dedicated the honour to all sports enthusiasts and athletes of India, particularly those from his home state of Odisha and the institutions he represents—KIIT and KISS.



Achyuta Samanta being presented the prestigious Grand Cross Award by International Volleyball Federation (FIVB) President Ary da Silva Graca Filho° in Portugal.

Building a Legacy in Sports

This award is only the latest in a series of honours that underscore Dr. Samanta's exceptional contributions. From being lauded with the Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puruskar by the President of India in 2022 to receiving accolades like the FICCI India Sports Award 2022 and the CII Sports Business Award 2023 for "Best Sports Facility," his journey has been defined by a relentless pursuit of excellence in sports education and infrastructure.

At the heart of this success lies KIIT's state-of-the-art sporting facilities, widely regarded as among the best in India. These facilities have become the training ground for Olympians like Dutee Chand, CA Bhavani Devi, Shivpal Singh, and Amit Rohidas—names that have etched India's name onto the global sports map. Over the years, KIIT has sponsored the

education and training of hundreds of athletes, creating opportunities where none existed.

A Vision Beyond Borders

Dr. Samanta's achievements in sports stem from his broader mission of holistic development. KIIT and KISS have championed the cause of nurturing young talents, providing them with world-class education alongside opportunities to excel in sports. His efforts have been lauded not only nationally but also internationally, with the Grand Cross Award serving as a crowning jewel.

The FIVB accolade is more than just recognition—it is an inspiration for others to follow in Dr. Samanta's footsteps. As he continues to build a legacy that blends education and sports, his work stands as a shining example of what vision and determination can achieve.